PROXY WAR



A battle of the babus has spiralled into a turf war in the BJP in Kanpur. After days of public sparring with DM Jitendra Pratap Singh, Chief Medical officer Hari Dutt Nemi was suspended, fuelling a split in the ruling party. Uttar Pradesh speaker Satish Mahana backed Nemi, as others rallied behind the DM and raised red flags with CM **Yogi Adityanath**. Rival Samajwadi Party suggests a deeper rift: between Yogi and deputy CM **Brajesh Pathak**.

Brothers Up in Arms



After feuding uncles, nephews and cousins, it seems to be brother vs brother in Maharashtra. Shiv Sena (Shinde faction) MLA **Nilesh Rane**, elder son of ex-Union minister Narayan Rane, first took umbrage at brother and BJP fisheries minister **Nitesh** for speaking against his party leaders. Now the latter has shared a screenshot of a WhatsApp conversation of Nilesh threatening a local BJP leader in Sindhudurg district. The sibling rivalry is raising eyebrows.

FLAGGING A CONCERN



Kerala's government-governor run-ins never seem to end. On June 19, CPI(M) leader and education minister V. Sivankutty walked out of a Raj Bhavan event, objecting to a prominent Bharat Mata image with a saffron flag. Governor **Rajendra Arlekar's** office called it "a grave insult", while the state government accused the guv of "transforming" the august office "into an RSS *shakha* (unit)". The war of words has now moved to the streets after senior BJP leader N. Sivarajan's alleged comment that the national tricolour should be replaced with the saffron flag.

Kaushik Deka with Rahul Noronha, Avaneesh Misra, Dhaval S. Kulkarni and Jeemon Jacob

TECH WATCH

By **Ajay Sukumaran**

THE RIGHT ADDRESS

The Department of Posts, on May 27, launched its Digital Postal Index Number (DIGIPIN) platform, which aims to transform India's addressing system

WHAT: Digipin is a unique 10-character alphanumeric code representing the latitude and longitude coordinates of a location. It aims to complement a regular postal address, which is based on locality, street and house number. An open-source, inter-operable addressing system, Digipin was developed by the Department of Posts in collaboration with IIT Hyderabad and the National Remote Sensing Centre, ISRO.

WHY: The aim is to improve delivery accuracy, logistics and service coverage, especially in areas with complex addresses. In rural and peri-urban areas, addresses are often descriptive, using landmarks and proximity references in place of standardised formats. For instance, there are wide variations in the area covered by a Postal Index Number (PIN) code—a system first introduced in 1972—with the average cover being around 170 sq. km per pin code. This translates to a radius of around 7 km. Given the scenario, service providers in areas such as e-commerce and navigation have introduced their own addressing methods, such as auto-fetching and Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) pins, to facilitate address discovery and delivery. A need for a more structured, machine-readable and user-friendly addressing layer was then recognised. Digipin is seen



as a component of digital public infrastructure for address management, just as UPI is for financial services.

HOW: Each Digipin code represents a 4m x 4m square, enabling a high level of precision for navigation, deliveries and emergency services, especially in areas with unstructured or changing addresses. It also helps in areas where no clear address exists, such as rural regions and forests.